

Ἡλιοδωρος ὁ Ἀλχημιστὴς καὶ Ποιητής

Heliodorus the Alchemist and Poet on the Mystical Art

eul_aid: sbq

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Heliodorus the Alchemist and Poet was a late antique author, likely active between the 4th and 6th centuries CE. No biographical details survive, and he is known solely as the author of an alchemical poem. He is distinguished from the novelist of the same name and is traditionally grouped among other Greco-Egyptian alchemical writers like Zosimus of Panopolis.

His sole surviving work is the *Carmen alchemicum*, or Alchemical Poem, a didactic composition in dactylic hexameter. The poem is part of the corpus of Greek alchemical writings and blends practical instruction with philosophical speculation.

Heliodorus contributed to the literary tradition of Greco-Egyptian alchemy, which conveyed technical knowledge in verse. His work, copied and studied through the Byzantine period and into the Renaissance, helped transmit alchemical concepts to the Latin West and the Islamic world, representing a continuation of the didactic poetic tradition within a specialized domain.

Works (1)

- Ἡλιοδώρου φιλοσόφου πρὸς Θεοδοσίον τὸν μέγαν · [Heliodorus to Theodosius the Great-the Mystical Art](#) · 16 passages